

Fancy  
**Bass**  
**Chords**  
and Their Voicings

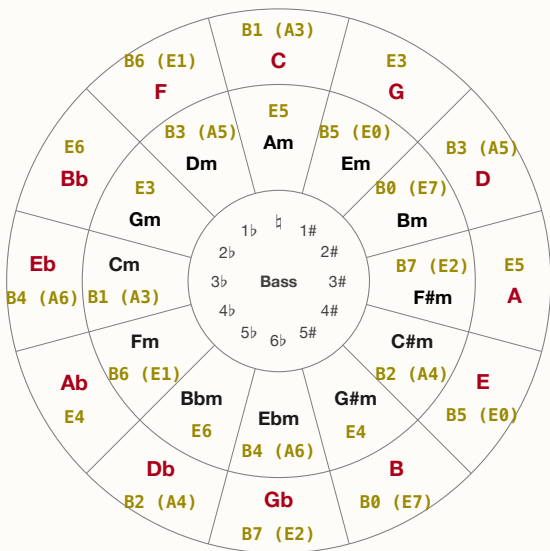
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**(B) E A D G**



<https://fancychords.com>

# Circle of Fifths



String and fret for each root: **A3** is the third fret of the A string.

Lowest that falls under the hand.

Five-string first, four-string in parentheses.

# Movable Shapes

Bass closed, so they move

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shape root on bottom example

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## fifths

|      |   |   |            |
|------|---|---|------------|
| 02xx | E | R | 13xx = F5  |
| x02x | A | R | x13x = Bb5 |
| xx02 | D | R | xx13 = Eb5 |
| 3x0x | E | R | 4x1x = Ab5 |

## major

|      |   |   |           |
|------|---|---|-----------|
| 02x1 | E | R | 13x2 = F  |
| 320x | E | R | 431x = Ab |
| x320 | A | R | x431 = Db |

## minor

|      |   |   |            |
|------|---|---|------------|
| 02x0 | E | R | 13x1 = Fm  |
| 310x | E | R | 421x = Abm |
| x310 | A | R | x421 = Dbm |

Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret.  
Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone.  
Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

# Numbers

Bass the major scale, degree by degree

|           | 1         | 2         | 3         | 4         | 5         | 6         | 7         |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| <b>C</b>  | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  |
| <b>Db</b> | <b>Db</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>Gb</b> | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  |
| <b>D</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> |
| <b>Eb</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  |
| <b>E</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G#</b> | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> | <b>D#</b> |
| <b>F</b>  | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  |
| <b>Gb</b> | <b>Gb</b> | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>Cb</b> | <b>Db</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  |
| <b>G</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> |
| <b>Ab</b> | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>Db</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  |
| <b>A</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G#</b> |
| <b>Bb</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  |
| <b>B</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> | <b>D#</b> | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G#</b> | <b>A#</b> |

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

# Root Positions

Bass

|           | (B) | E  | A  | D  | G  |
|-----------|-----|----|----|----|----|
| <b>C</b>  | 1   | 8  | 3  | 10 | 5  |
| <b>Db</b> | 2   | 9  | 4  | 11 | 6  |
| <b>D</b>  | 3   | 10 | 5  | 0  | 7  |
| <b>Eb</b> | 4   | 11 | 6  | 1  | 8  |
| <b>E</b>  | 5   | 0  | 7  | 2  | 9  |
| <b>F</b>  | 6   | 1  | 8  | 3  | 10 |
| <b>Gb</b> | 7   | 2  | 9  | 4  | 11 |
| <b>G</b>  | 8   | 3  | 10 | 5  | 0  |
| <b>Ab</b> | 9   | 4  | 11 | 6  | 1  |
| <b>A</b>  | 10  | 5  | 0  | 7  | 2  |
| <b>Bb</b> | 11  | 6  | 1  | 8  | 3  |
| <b>B</b>  | 0   | 7  | 2  | 9  | 4  |

Fret for the root of each key on each string.  
Everything else is measured from there.

# What to Play Under

Bass      degrees from the root

|       |           |       |             |
|-------|-----------|-------|-------------|
| major | R 3 5     | °7    | R b3 b5 6   |
| m     | R b3 5    | m7b5  | R b3 b5 b7  |
| 5     | R 5       | 7sus4 | R 4 5 b7    |
| +     | R 3 #5    | 7b5   | R 3 b5 b7   |
| °     | R b3 b5   | 7#5   | R 3 #5 b7   |
| sus2  | R 2 5     | 9     | R 9 3 5 b7  |
| sus4  | R 4 5     | maj9  | R 9 3 5 7   |
| 6     | R 3 5 6   | m9    | R 9 b3 5 b7 |
| m6    | R b3 5 6  | add9  | R 9 3 5     |
| 6/9   | R 9 3 5 6 | madd9 | R 9 b3 5    |
| 7     | R 3 5 b7  | 7b9   | R b9 3 5 b7 |
| maj7  | R 3 5 7   | 7#9   | R b3 3 5 b7 |
| m7    | R b3 5 b7 | m11   | R 9 b3 4 5  |
|       |           |       | b7          |

Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.

Add the tone that names the chord, the **b3** or the **b7**, only when it wants hearing.

The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.

# Patterns

Bass counted from the root

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## Root + fifth + octave

The default. Works under

anything in the key.

degree **R** **5** **8**

string R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R2 R2

## Major arpeggio

Major, maj7, 6.

degree **R** **5** **8** **3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R2 R1

## Minor arpeggio

Minor, m7, m6.

degree **R** **5** **8** **b3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R2 R0

## Dominant seventh

Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to

the four.

degree **R** **5** **b7** **3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R0 R1

## Minor seventh

The two and the six chord.

degree **R** **5** **b7** **b3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R0 R0

## Walking approach

Leading into the next chord.

degree **R** **5** **6** **b7**

string R 1+R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R2 R4 R0

# Tunings

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## **Bass** (B) E A D G

The guitar's lowest four strings, an octave down.



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## **Fancy Bass Chords and Their Voicings**

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Downloads and a printable copy:

<https://fancychords.com>

Source and corrections:

<http://github.com/linenoise/voicings>

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